

in notes and tracking, some of these tools make use of cloud servers so do not put sensitive information into them.

Alfred

Alfred is an application launcher and productivity tool for macOS.

The core app is free to download and use, but the paid Powerpack enables more powerful searching, a fantastic clipboard history feature, app integrations, easy access to shell commands, and more.

It's a great tool for developers and general productivity enthusiasts alike.

The clipboard history feature is nicely integrated with many tools, and for example will forget passwords copied from 1Password after they have been pasted.

Alfred adds the ability to create custom searches. Here are two to search the docs and the handbook.

url

<https://docs.gitlab.com/search/?q={query}>

url

<https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/stq={query}&stp=1>

Read Searching using Alfred to learn more and be able to automatically add them.

There is also a repo maintained by GitLab team members with GitLab related workflows.

Brain.fm

Brain.fm (free trial) provides music specially designed to help you focus, relax, meditate, recharge, sleep (great for plane rides).

It's not just music though.

They use scientifically validated brainwave manipulations to get results.

It is AMAZING and really does work.

Make sure to use with headphones, and give it 10-15 minutes for your brain to get used to it. (\$6.95/\$15.99/\$47.40 per month/quarter/year)

Calendly

Note: Google Calendar has added support to create appointment schedules, which are similar to the functionality provided by Calendly.

Calendly connects to your Google Calendar so people outside GitLab can easily book a time with you.

If you are scheduling a meeting with a GitLab team-member, please use Google Calendar and follow handbook guidance when scheduling a meeting.

1. Set up a Calendly. First sign up with your GitLab email address, then accept the terms and conditions and then authenticate with your Google SSO.

1. Link it to your GitLab Google Calendar to make it possible for people to schedule a call with you.

1. Get your personal meeting room URL by going to Zoom meeting settings, selecting the Personal Room tab, and copying the value of Invite Link (do not use Copy the invitation).

1. If you are using the Basic Calendly Subscription (Unpaid) you will only be able to set-up one event type at a time i.e. either a 15, 30, 45 or 60 minute event - teams making use of one of the Paid Subscription Tiers such as Customer Support will be able to set up more than one event type.

1. Set up the desired time slot with the following event description text (replacing text in {} with your information) we will be using 45 minutes for the illustration purposes below:

> This will be a Zoom Meeting at {Zoom personal meeting room URL}

>

> Question? Please email me. {your GitLab email}

1. Set the event name to 45 Minute Meeting.

1. Change the event link to 45min.

1. The event description needs to be copied to the 15, 30 and 60 minute meetings too.

1. If you intend to use any of the other event types, make sure to add this to their event descriptions as well.

1. For people outside of GitLab Inc, send them your Calendly link that links directly to the 45 minute time slot: "Are any of the times on <https://calendly.com/XXXXX/45min/> convenient for you? If so please book one, if not please let me know what times are good for you and we'll find an alternative."

1. Update your availability on Calendly Event Types by clicking the action cog and then the edit option on an event type (For Example: 15 minute meeting) and in the event details clicking on the "When can people book this event?" section then clicking the "Availability" section.

Here you can set your working hours during which you want to accept meetings, and on the "Advanced" tab you can set the minimum scheduling notice you want enforced.

Although Calendly does synchronize with Google Calendar to show your availability you may wish to set extra restrictions in Calendly.

You can use the "Copy Availability From" option on all the other events you have configured one event.

Keep in mind that unlike normal Google Calendar events, Calendly events are not automatically synchronized between both parties when changes are made.

If an event needs to be canceled or modified, make sure to use Calendly to do so.

Freedom

If you find yourself switching to websites you find distracting, especially during periods that require focus, and you worry it may affect your productivity, consider using Freedom.

Their browser extensions, mobile apps, and desktop apps block distracting websites and apps for the duration of a configurable session.

If you find yourself typing f and hitting enter from muscle memory, you will not be scrolling through endless pages of photos of your friends' lunches.

Paste

Paste for macOS is a clipboard manager that stores everything you copy and optionally syncs

across all your devices.

It allows you to organize frequently copied data in pinboards, so that you do not need to copy the same data over and over, provides search, multiple paste and has nice visual user interface.

Pomodoro technique

The Pomodoro Technique is a simple time management process that can be used to boost productivity by dividing time into "work" and "break" intervals.

In brief, each half-hour block of time is divided into a 25 minute work session followed by a 5 minute break session.

Do this twice per hour until the day is done and marvel at how much you've finished.

Various Chrome extensions, Firefox add-ons"), mobile apps, desktop apps, and even fancy physical alarm clocks are available to help you track your intervals, but you can use almost any timer you have on hand—even and especially that cute little tomato timer in your kitchen.

Quitter

Quitter (Free) will switch off apps for you after some period of inactivity.

Consider using this to hide Slack after a while to reduce your urge to check new messages all the time. Quitter is only available for the Mac.

Raycast

Raycast is a productivity tool similar to Alfred and Spotlight on macOS. Download the app and select your preferred shortcut. You can also replace spotlight entirely by choosing cmd + space as shortcut.

The core app provides many workflows built-in, extensions from the store can be installed either directly from the web, or by using the built-in extension search.

There is an unofficial extension maintained by GitLab team members to search the GitLab documentation, the Handbook, and the Pajamas Design System.

Please do not use extensions for GitLab using a personal access token (PAT) for security reasons.

TripMode

TripMode (\$7.99) lets you control which apps can use the internet.

This is especially useful when you're working on a cellular/metered connection. TripMode is only available for the Mac.

Stream Deck

If you're not good at remembering hotkeys, or you are in need of a multi-step automation, a Stream deck or similar might be the right thing for you. A Stream Deck allows you to program buttons to execute complex sequences of actions with a single press.

How to use Apple Shortcuts with the Stream deck

Besides the official integrations, you can also use the Apple Shortcuts app to have an easy way of defining actions without any programming knowledge and without the need of any external plugins.

1. Add a Shortcut in the Shortcut app that you want to bind to a button on the Stream deck to.
 - Note: Don't use a too complicated name as we will need the name to identify the Shortcut to run later. Blank spaces do work though.
1. Save the following code as ShortcutScript.scpt (you can rename it, just the scpt extension is important) on your computer. The Stream deck will reference this script so save it somewhere you can find it later and keep in mind that deleting it will break the button as well.

```
applescript
on run argv
    tell application "Shortcuts Events"
        set shortcutName to item 1 of argv
        run shortcut shortcutName
    end tell
end run
```

1. Add a new Action in your Stream deck application. Use System > Open as template for this. You can freely choose the title of the action, this is only for your own reference and does not have to do anything with the Shortcut. As for the App/File - you can use the file locator to reference the .scpt file from step 2. Afterwards you have to click back into the input field and delete the apostrophes that were added by the file locator around the path. Now we can pass the name of the Shortcut to the script, if your Shortcut had blank spaces in its name you have to enclose it in quotes. So f.e for a Shortcut called Active Speaker the App/File input should contain the following /path/to/script/ShortcutScript.scpt "Activate speaker"

1. Add more actions as you need them. Since the .scpt file is parameterized you don't have to repeat step 2 and can just use the script for all Shortcuts!

Other Stream deck use cases

- Switching scenes in OBS
- Muting your microphone
- Switching between speaker and headphones
- Switching between languages and keyboard layouts
- Starting timers (there are some great pomodoro apps that show the remaining time on the button)
- Enabling/disabling Do not disturb mode
- Control lightning and change scenes

Text editors

GitHub Copilot

GitHub released Copilot, an AI-powered tool for in-situ suggestions within VSCode, in 2021.

It's an interesting and exciting tool. However at this time it does not guarantee that the code being suggested is strictly sourced from codebases governed by an open source license compatible with our own project which could lead to license conflicts. Until the licensing of the suggestions is established, please don't use Copilot.

Video calling

Krisp

Krisp will mute background noise when you're in a noisy environment so you can hear and be heard more easily on calls.

Shush

\$4.99 tool for macOS that lets you set a hotkey (for example fn) to mute your microphone ("push-to-talk" or "push-to-mute").

Never again will you have to switch your window focus to Google Hangouts or Zoom to speak or mute.

The icon will show the current state of your mic input (x means muted).

With a right click (or your configured hotkey) you can switch from push to talk to push to mute.

Don't forget to unblock your mic in Zoom/Google Hangouts immediately after joining.

Be warned that page up with fn+down arrow will activate it.

Use space for page down instead of fn+up arrow.

Warning: Check your headset compatibility before purchase.

Many USB headsets are unmutable.

Shush alternative for Linux

If you use Linux (examples are Arch, Ubuntu or Fedora) you can create a system-wide keyboard shortcut to mute/unmute your mic.

Please note that it only works for Linux distributions which use ALSA for sounds (most popular Linux distributions use ALSA).

All you need to do is go to your desktop environment's Keyboard Settings and create a custom shortcut with the command `amixer set Capture toggle` and assign a key combination of your choice (e.g. Pause Break key).

Once this is done, you can mute/unmute your mic using the assigned keyboard shortcut while you're in any application.

Refer to this [original answer on Askubuntu](#) to learn more.

Webex

GitLab uses Zoom as the primary video collaboration platform for internal and external communications. Some of our customers and partners have different preferred tools and to facilitate the communication with those parties, GitLab provides licenses for WebEx. This service is only provided to team members that have a business need to host meetings and where Zoom is not accepted.

- To request access to those tools, create an access request and provide a justification for access.

- Consider installing their native app. Team members have reported issues when trying to use WebEx in Safari, so we recommend using other browsers such as Google Chrome when hosting or joining meetings.
- Before attending a Webex meeting you can test to ensure your Webex is setup correctly by joining a test meeting.
- The in-browser plugin the screen sharing sometimes doesn't work.

Whereby

Whereby allows you to instantly create a free video chat room for up to 4 participants with no login and no installation.

It also offers a free reliable mobile video conference app.

Videos, GIFs, and screenshots

Loom

Loom (Free) is a handy Chrome plugin tool for video walkthroughs.

Nice tool for demo recordings and internal/external documentation. Note, Loom videos are public by default - ensure you are not exposing data that should remain private. GitLab does have a Loom workspace, for a license please follow the instructions on the tech stack page

Language and translation

DeepL

The GitLab handbook and most other content is written in English. Even if a non-native speaker's English is pretty good there might be times when the content is too sophisticated and a translation is welcome. Avoiding tedious copy and paste into another browser tab or app can easily be achieved by using the DeepL translator.

DeepL is available as a Web site but also as a Mac app for free. Using a shortcut on MacOS takes selected text from the handbook right into the app and starts translating. Linux users can only use a Chrome extension and right-click to open another tab for the Web version.

SECTION: tools-and-tips/personal-vpn.md

GitLab does not use a corporate VPN. We have selected NordLayer as our personal VPN solution.

What is a personal VPN?

A VPN (Virtual Private Network) is the extension of a private network across a public network, allowing the users of the private network a level of protection and privacy to their network traffic that might be lacking if crossing a public network. Typically the private traffic is "tunneled" and encrypted with safeguards built in to prevent leakage of data that could lead to compromising situations with the public network, such as network-based attacks or private data being revealed. Corporations with centralized headquarters and private internal networks in their offices have used VPNs for years to allow for remote workers to access internal systems when working remotely. As a remote-only company, GitLab does not use a corporate VPN.

A personal VPN is similar to the corporate VPN in that it uses some of the same methods of tunneling, encryption, and safeguards that the corporate VPN uses, except it is intended for personal use. Instead of a corporate VPN server, the company providing the personal VPN service has its own server and simply uses it as a jump point to reach resources while protecting the user from some of the same dangers the corporate users face.

The personal VPN has a few other advantages. All personal VPN companies maintain their servers in different locations around the world, which not only helps with speed (there is a slight performance hit with using a personal VPN) but allows a user to access resources that are geographically restricted (watch a YouTube video not available in your country), avoid monitoring by your ISP (Internet Service Provider) of which websites you access, bypass Internet censorship, and many others. As a result, personal VPN service providers will compete with each other by offering enhanced privacy features, hundreds of servers in a variety of locations, support for various tunneling and communication options, end user device support, and more.

Why would a GitLab team member use one?

There are a few reasons why a GitLab team member might want to use NordLayer:

- You use public Wi-Fi frequently. This could be because of travel, deciding to work from a coffee shop for the afternoon, or some other reason.
- You are using a private network but you do not trust it to be secure. You are working from a relative's home, a university network, or some other network that is not public but may not have tight security controls (or they are unknown).
- You share your home network with housemates that work at other companies, are students, and even neighbors, and you'd like to ensure that your communications remain private.
- You wish to isolate your work environment from your home environment.

Important tips

- Be consistent in your usage. If your goal is to secure your device while using public Wi-Fi, always use the VPN.
- Get familiar with the VPN solution before you need to use it. If you are using one while traveling, don't try it out for the first time at the airport while waiting to board your flight. Try it out at home.
- Remember that a VPN is not a guarantee of complete security and privacy. Keep the software up-to-date with the latest patches, just like other applications and your operating system. Also remember that like any other organization, personal VPN vendors can have breaches, security flaws, and other issues that could compromise your security and privacy. Stay alert, check with the vendor's website, and keep an eye on security as there will certainly be discussion of such issues as the Security Team hears about them.
- There may be reasons you cannot use a VPN while working. For example, if you are supporting a government customer, you might only be able to assist that customer while in that country and only use network connections within the geographic confines of that country. The VPN might route your travel through different jurisdictions, and therefore should not be used.
- The same basic rules for personal usage that apply to your work laptop also continue to apply while using the personal VPN.
- Questions? Ask in the security Slack channel.

SECTION: tools-and-tips/rubocop.md

RuboCop is used for running static code analysis on your Ruby code.

"Magic" one-liners

RuboCop-ing a set of files

You can combine the tips about listing files on the Git page with RuboCop.

- To RuboCop the current commit - `git diff-tree --no-commit-id --name-only -r HEAD --diff-filter AMT | xargs bundle exec rubocop`
- To RuboCop the working tree changes - `git diff --name-only --diff-filter AMT | xargs bundle exec rubocop`
- To RuboCop all of the changes from the branch - `git diff --name-only master --diff-filter AMT | xargs bundle exec rubocop`

SECTION: tools-and-tips/slack.md

In general

Slack is an important part of GitLab's strategy for communication between team members. As such, extra care needs to be given to ensure the safety and integrity of data.

Profile

Fill in your Slack profile, as we use Slack profiles as our Team Directory to stay in touch with other team members. Important fields include:

- Photo (unobscured photo of your face rather than an artificial avatar, for better human connection and easier recognition)
- Title (should be your GitLab job title, including your department and team name)
- GitLab.com profile (set the Display text to your @gitlabusername so that people don't need to click the link to identify your username)
- Time zone (useful for other GitLab team members to see when you're available)
- Working hours (can help others to identify the times you are generally available)
- GitLab Birthdays (opt in or out of the birthday celebrations in Slack by selecting yes or no)
- Location field for City / State / Province and Country (optional)
- You can add your personal phone number including country code (optional)
- Consider changing your "Display Name" if you prefer to be addressed by a nickname
- Consider adding your pronouns in the Pronouns field. By making it normal to set pronouns we create a more inclusive environment for people who use non-traditional pronouns.
- Consider adding a pronunciation guide in the "Name Pronunciation" field to help others to pronounce your name correctly (e.g. sid see-brandij for Sid Sijbrandij).
- Consider adding a "Name recording" to help with name pronunciation.
- Do not enter anything in the G-Cal Booking! field unless you would like to set up and make

use of a Calendly Account

Channels

Channels are a core feature of Slack. This section describes tools and tips for managing Slack channels. For a list of common GitLab Slack channels, please see the [GitLab Communication Chat](#).

Browse Channels

You can browse all available GitLab channels by clicking on "Channels" on the left pane in the Slack app.

From there, you can see every channel, who created it, and how many members there are.

Feel free to ask for recommendations from other team members for their favorite channels.

Every team member is automatically added to the company-fyi and whats-happening-at-gitlab channels, where announcements are made and information for the entire company is shared.

There are also a few default channels that every new hire is added to, such as: celebrations, newteammembers, questions, random, & thanks; these channels are optional, but we think they are a great place for team members to interact and get to know each other.

Organize Channels in Sidebar Sections

Slack now supports organizing channels in sections. Previously this only was possible through "Starred" channels. Navigate into the Slack preferences and select the Sidebar navigation item. Click on Create Section to create a new section on the left sidebar. You can also do that from the settings menu of each existing section.

Feel free to organize this with your most frequent used channels, or specific team grouping.

You can drag and drop and also hide sections. You can for example create the info section and add company-fyi and whats-happening-at-gitlab as channels. Additionally, add the team section and move all related channels there.

Consider using Slack's **Starred channel** function to spotlight three categories of channels, its **Mute function** to quiet channels which are pulling your focus away too often, and most importantly, its Mark all messages as read function (easily toggled by pressing Shift and Esc simultaneously while on a desktop) to achieve an instantly clear slate.

An example of three spotlight channels approach is below. Slack allows you to organize your sidebar of starred channels with **custom sections** to visibly raise or lower their priority level, giving you control over what you see first.

1. Channels important to my job (e.g. a team member in Corporate Marketing may star marketing, corp-mktg, newswire, external-comms, website, handbook)
1. Channels important to GitLab (e.g. company-fyi, whats-happening-at-gitlab, team-member-updates, e-group, ceo, new-vacancies)
1. Channels important to my interests (e.g. travel, remote, daily-gratitude, mentalhealthaware, intheparenthood, women, diversityinclusionandbelonging)

Sort channels and direct messages with stars

To sort direct messages and channels, open the direct message or channel and click on the star

icon.

For details, see Star channel or direct message.

Channels Access

In addition to GitLab team-members, designated groups such as the Core Team members and advisors outside of GitLab may be granted access to our Slack channels.

However, internal channels that start with a will be restricted to GitLab team-members who have been invited to those channels only.

Any confidential conversations regarding our customers should be restricted only to a channels.

The rationale for internal channels is that it could be a breach of many of our contracts for third parties to have knowledge of GitLab customers.

This is especially the case when third parties could be customers' competitors.

Invite

There are multiple ways to invite people into a Slack channel.

The easiest way is to use the invite command by typing `/invite @jenny`.

Avoid inviting people through a mention message.

E.g. `@jenny` as it can create a message that distracts others.

Change Group DMs to Private Channels

If you are in a group direct message with multiple people, you can change it to a private channel, in order to avoid extra pings and allow additional team members to be added or removed to the channel.

In Slack Enterprise Grid, if you start a group DM and then it is converted to a channel, the channel ends up in "all workspaces". "All workspace" channels have no retention limit, which contradicts our policy of 90 day retention. To remediate this, we have a script that will daily move the channels into our main GitLab workspace. If you are in an affected channel, you will receive a message from Slackbot that states:

"Slack Owner has removed <channel> from all other "GitLab" workspaces using the channel management tool. Only people from "GitLab" can access the channel now. Learn more."

Do not convert group DMs to private channels within the "GitLab - Finance" workspace or any secondary workspace as they will be converted and end up in our main "GitLab" workspace. Instead, start a new private channel and add the participants to it.

Change private channels to public channels

Only Slack administrators can change a private channel to a public channel.

To request that an existing private channel be made public, submit an access request.

Managing noise and creating focus in Slack

Slack can be a disorderly place in its default state. Consider implementing the below to add structure and focus, but remember that there will likely be more useful information shared on

Slack than you are able to ingest and process on a daily basis, regardless of your approach.

While an intentional effort to organize is important, remember that it's impossible to know everything. As a team, we may spot information that is missed by others, and we should surface that information when pertinent as we strive to see others succeed. For managing Slack channels, consider blocking a set period of time to review certain channels that makes the most sense for you (i.e. multiple times a day, daily, weekly).

Below are helpful links to best practices and tips on managing your notifications and reducing noise in Slack. We encourage you to regularly check your notification settings to ensure you get more notifications of what is important/relevant to you, and less of what isn't.

- Reduce noise in Slack
- Configure Your Notifications
- Guide to Desktop Notifications
- Channel-specific and group DM Notifications
- Display only unread conversations
- GitLab team member Brendan O'leary on how he uses Slack

Display only unread conversations

With lots of channels and direct messages, Slack can become overwhelming. To help keep track of activity on Slack, and to simplify the interface, consider displaying only unread conversations.

Slack Reminders

Slack reminders help you to remember things without having to keep it all in your head. You can set reminders for yourself or other team members. You will receive a notification at the specified time.

You can use natural language with the /remind command.
Type /remind help to get some tips.
For full information on Slack reminders see the Slack help.

Set aside time to work through notifications

Building dedicated time into your day can help minimize the distractions that Slack can create. Consider using a 15 or 30 minute block in your morning or afternoon to enjoy a cup of coffee and catch up on messages you might have missed. When the time you set comes to an end, close out of the Slack app and move on to your next project. Having a set end time can help you feel more in control, and serves as a reminder that it's impossible to know everything

Scheduled Slack Messages

When working in an all-remote environment it can be sometimes difficult to draw the line between home and work, and it can be especially tempting to check Slack messages after hours. To foster a more inclusive environment at GitLab, we can avoid sending messages outside of the recipient's working hours by composing a message but not sending it until the recipient begins their working day. In Slack, you can schedule messages to be sent later, which helps reduce

immediate disruptions. You can still edit, delete, or cancel scheduled messages before they are sent, making it a very family-friendly tool to use. This approach aligns with our bias towards asynchronous communication.

It's simple: when composing a message, click the arrow icon (next to the paper plane icon) to schedule it for a later time.

For more details on scheduling messages in Slack, please refer to Slack help.

Minimize Visual Distractions

Animated images and emoji can add meaning to conversation, but they can also be distracting. If you would prefer to have static images and emoji, disable the animation. For details, see [Manage animated images and emoji](#).

Slack Status

Slack allows you to set your status for your fellow GitLab team members by using your choice of standard messages such as "Away" and "Lunch" or a custom message and your choice of emoji.

If you're off work for a holiday or vacation you can update your status by using Time Off by Deel.

This is a great way to let your team know whether you are available.

To have your Slack status automatically set to "In a meeting" based on your Google Calendar, add the Google Calendar app to your Slack account.

Do Not Disturb Hours

Slack now supports "Do Not Disturb Hours" so you won't be pinged in the middle of the night or while you are dealing with family matters.

You can set your "Do Not Disturb Hours" by clicking on the bell at the top of the left pane in the Slack app.

You also have the option of snoozing for 20 minutes or up to 24 hours.

Note: Do Not Disturb can be overridden in the event of an emergency.

See [Slack documentation](#) for more information.

Quick Switcher

Quick Switcher is a great feature to know about if you want to get productive with Slack.

As the name suggests, it allows you to switch between channels and direct messages quickly.

Invoke it with `Cmd+K` on Mac or `Ctrl+K` on Windows or Linux and start typing the name of the person to chat with or the channel you are interested in.

You can then navigate the suggestions with `↓` and `↑` keys and hit `enter` to select.

Unfurling Links in Messages

Slack has a built-in feature to Unfurl links included in messages posted to Slack.

This will post a preview of the link alongside the message.

You can remove the unfurled preview of the link by hitting the "x" in the top-left of the preview.

This will then prompt you to confirm removing the attachment, which you can hit "Yes, remove".

In the confirmation prompt you may also see a checkbox to "Disable future attachments from this website".

As a workspace admin if you select the disable option this will denylist the link/domain across the workspace and will impact every user.

If you do happen to denylist a link or a domain, they can be modified in the Workspace admin portal under Settings & Permissions.

If you see a team member share posts with multiple link previews that you think are distracting, in channels like whats-happening-at-gitlab, consider acting in the spirit of Everyone is a moderator and either:

- Letting them know in a DM that it's adding noise to their message.
- Reacting to their message with the :consider-removing-link-previews-to-keep-the-channel-tidy-please: emoji.

Custom theme

The interface colors can be customized in Slack.

This is especially useful when using multiple slack accounts, setting up different themes makes it really easy to differentiate them instantly.

The theme selector is available under Preferences > Themes.

In order to setup a GitLab theme, send yourself the following message:

643685,634489,FC6D26,ffffff,71558f,ffffff,FCA326,e24329, and press the Switch sidebar theme button.

Slack Apps

Many applications can integrate with Slack.

Recommended apps:

1. Google Calendar - By integrating your calendar with Slack, you'll get notifications about meetings directly in Slack.

Most important - 1 minute before a meeting begins, you'll receive a message with the meeting info, including a link to join meetings that are occurring in Zoom.

You can set up the integration by typing /gcal into any message field.

Need to add a new app to Slack

GitLab has chosen to restrict the ability to install apps, and we have a process to approve or restrict certain apps for our workspace. In order to add a new app to Slack, you need to create a vendor approval issue. Once that's approved by all parties, please request approval to add the app to Slack:

1. Make sure the app hasn't been pre-approved by our team by clicking on Apps in the left sidebar and find Available Apps. To find pre-approved apps in the App Directory, click Pre-Approved below Categories in the left column.

1. If the app isn't pre-approved, you can click on Add to Slack.

1. Add a custom message with more context about your request and also link the vendor approval issue.

1. Click Submit. You'll receive a direct message from Slackbot when your request has been reviewed by the team.

Please note that this is only required for new apps that have not been reviewed or approved. If your request is to add a new process or update an existing process for how an application works in slack, please refer to our Business Technology Change Management process.

Slackbots

We have a few slackbots to help us with frequently asked questions and other slackbots that directly help us to remain inclusive in our language and align closely with our Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging Value.

The following list is reflective of the ones we use for Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging and the suggested changes to use. This list is representative, not complete; terms will be added and removed as we iterate on the list.

As a GitLab Team Member, you can view the active slackbots that we use in Slack, under: GitLab > Customize Your Workspace > Slackbot.

| hey guys, hi guys, you guys, salesman, salesmen, businessman, businessmen | Are you including people of multiple genders? Please consider using "everyone," "team," "y'all," or similar instead. You can read more about inclusive language in our handbook |

| on your toes, on anybody's toes | It's probably okay.

As companies grow, their speed of decision making goes down since there are more people involved. We should counteract that by having short toes, and feel comfortable letting others contribute to our domain. |

| aggressive | Did you mean ambitious? |

| gitlabber, gitlabbers | The term gitlabber is a commonly misused term. Please use "GitLab team member" instead. You can read more about this in our handbook |

Security

Sign-in requirements

Every 90 days, all users will be logged out of Slack and will need to re-authenticate on each of their devices via Okta. This is to ensure that all BYOD devices are registered with a current Okta Verify client and are visible in the Okta Administration dashboard. It will also ensure that there are no indefinite sessions on devices temporarily exempted from Okta Verify Device Trust.

Profile deletion

Beginning in December 2024, and going forward in June and December of each year, CorpSec will request from Slack support to delete profiles that have been deactivated for more than five years. For former team members who have left GitLab less than 5 years ago, we will use the API to remove all fields except for Name, GitLab Email, Title and GitLab.com username, which will

remain for current team members to find historical context on earlier epics, merge requests and issues.

SECTION: tools-and-tips/zoom.md

In general

Zoom is an important part of GitLab's strategy for communication between team members. As such, extra care needs to be given to ensure the safety and integrity of data.

A note on privacy and security

There have been a number of security researchers looking at Zoom, which has resulted in numerous articles (some quite sensational) regarding the privacy and security of the product. Here are a few important things to keep in mind, especially as you read through the Zoom tips below:

- Always ensure your operating system as well as the Zoom application are up-to-date with the latest patches.
- Ensure you've followed the laptop configuration guidelines.
- Make a customized Personal link.
- Enable the "Waiting Room" for your meetings.
- You can set a password for your meetings, but remember if your meetings are in your calendar, anyone who can view your calendar will see the password if you include it in the meeting invite.

Calendars should only be made available to other GitLab team members.

See this tip for more details.

Use caution when sharing calendar events with customers and trusted third parties.

Public meetings such as webinars can use a password if you prefer, but use this in conjunction with the Waiting Room so the meeting host can approve each attendee.

- It is recommended to include an embedded password in the URL, so if you're using this option do not share this URL publicly.
- Starting 2020-09-27, all meetings will be required to have a Passcode or a Waiting Room enabled.
- With Zoom version 5.4.7, you can selectively turn on the requirement that meeting attendees must be authenticated to join a meeting (not recommended for customer-facing calls or recruitment interviews). There is a Zoom article with more information.
- Zoom supports end-to-end encryption if no Zoom connectors are in use.

More details can be found [here](#).

GitLab makes use of Zoom connectors for telephones, whenever we do webinars, and the vast majority of group meetings that end up on YouTube.

Any time we are livestreaming via YouTube, we are using a connector.

Any time we are recording a meeting, we are using a connector.

If you need to ensure end-to-end encryption in a Zoom meeting either because of a customer request or some possible compliance reason, only use Zoom clients, do not use telephony, and do not record the meeting.

- During a meeting, the host has a "Security" button at the bottom of the screen.

This can be used to turn off and on the Waiting Room and to "lock" a meeting to prevent

others from attending.

Use these as needed to secure your meeting.

Also note there has been an increase in what is known as "Zoombombing" which involves an uninvited party trying to brute force their way into an existing Zoom meeting.

- At the time of this update, a global pandemic is occurring which has dramatically increased both the usage of Zoom for legitimate users, and the number of individuals doing Zoombombing.
- Zoombombing parties are occurring where individuals are sharing tips and information online regarding meetings to access.
- Tools are being written to automate some of the steps in finding open and unprotected meetings.
- Simple steps such as a Waiting Room, a meeting password, and only allowing authenticated meeting attendees can easily prevent such activity. To this end, by default we now turn on passwords for all meetings. To ensure these settings are in place, navigate to your Zoom browser extension settings, and ensure that both "One-time Meeting ID" and "Require Meeting password" are checked.
- Most of the recommendations given here are defaults as set by IT Ops, but always double-check to ensure a safe Zoom meeting.

GitLab's Zoom account has End-to-End Encryption enabled.

This may impact performance, so if you run into any issues, let People Ops know.

If there is a meeting active, a new meeting cannot start until the host ends the meeting or all participants leave, so you can only be in one meeting at a time.

The People Ops or IT Ops teams can force end a meeting by logging into Zoom with the credentials in 1Password, going to My Meetings, finding the meeting they would like to end, then selecting "End." This will allow the next meeting to begin.

Setting up a Zoom Meeting

To set up a Zoom meeting, sign in via Okta and share the link for your "personal meeting room" with your participants.

Using your personal link versus a unique/random link

Your personal link is a great way to provide a consistent, easy-to-read-and-remember meeting room for colleagues and customers.

However, there are some drawbacks to reusing the same meeting, such as participants joining an ongoing meeting when two are scheduled back to back.

In some cases it may be better to use a unique meeting link.

Here are some good use cases for the personal link:

- Recurring or standing meetings, especially those with a large or frequently changing attendee list.
- First meeting with a customer, where a simple and readable link is helpful for ease of participation and branding.

- Webinar or training session where your Zoom link may be shared in a display (non-clickable) format, and will need to be typed in manually by attendees.
- Interviews so the candidate can see your name for the meeting link, not a random number. Keep in mind candidates may be scheduled for 3-5 interviews all at once and we don't want to create confusion.

Here are some good use cases for a unique link:

- Meetings scheduled in rapid succession or back-to-back, to ensure only the invitees for each meeting arrive to the right session.
- A meeting where privacy is a principal concern (this dovetails with the first bullet point)
- A meeting where most attendees will be joining via a shared link or calendar invite, and will not need to type the link manually.

Use your best judgement on when to use each type of link.

Not all situations will fit cleanly into any of the given scenarios, and your needs may vary.

Allow for browsers

Not everyone has a Zoom client, so you can allow for invitees to choose to use Zoom from the browser.

Go to Settings > In Meeting (Advanced) and click next to "Show a 'Join from your browser' link" to make this option available in your meeting invites.

The browser version of Zoom is not as full-featured as the regular client, but it doesn't force an invitee to download the Zoom client.

This also mitigates the issue of potential weak communication encryption since the browser uses HTTPS instead of Zoom's proprietary encryption scheme.

Large meeting considerations

It can be distracting when a call with a large number of attendees has folks joining unmuted. For Assembly, CEO AMAs, and other meetings in which we expect an attendance of over 25 folks, meetings should be scheduled, so that folks enter on mute. These folks can then opt to unmute as required to participate in the conversation.

If a team member in a meeting is not on mute but creating sound that is distracting, any other team member should feel empowered to put this person on mute. A person must be a co-host or host to put someone on mute. If you are the host and you'd like help with muting people, ensure that "co-host" is enabled in your Zoom settings. During meetings, you can click on individuals in the meeting and designate them as "co-hosts."

During your Zoom Meeting

Zoom can be minimized during a meeting (cmd-m on macOS) to a small window staying on top of all applications.

This tip is very handy when using a small screen: it allows to see the participant(s) and use other applications at the same time without worrying about the screen layout.

Recording in Zoom

In order to be able to record your Zoom meetings you must first enable recordings in your Zoom profile.

You can access this page at Recording Settings.

You need to be signed in to have the ability to record.

To auto-record meetings set up cloud recording.

You can also configure Zoom to save to the cloud automatically.

Go to "My Meeting Settings" and find the "Recording" section, then click on "Cloud Recording".

Setting the topic of the meeting is important, otherwise all meetings will be recorded with a generic name.

Once recording is complete, your videos will not appear in the "Recordings" section of your Zoom account.

If the meeting topic in Zoom (editable by logging into <https://zoom.us/>) contains the text [REC], these recordings will

automatically be saved to a folder on Google Drive under GitLab Videos Recorded (accessible from Google Hidden shared drives).

The name of the folder will be prefixed by the host's e-mail address. For example, if the host is someuser@gitlab.com and the meeting title is Company Training [REC], the folder will appear as someuser@gitlab.com-Company Training. The script (from the zoom-sync project) will sync the recordings every hour.

To make it easier for meetings to be uploaded automatically without changing the title, the sync script also uses an allow list.

If a meeting title matches the provided regex with the given host's e-mail address, the meeting will also be uploaded to Google Drive. File a merge request to change the current list.

Consider setting your default recording view to "Gallery view".

To do this:

1. Login to zoom.us.
1. Click the Settings tab on the left side bar, then the Recording tab on the top horizontal options.
1. Make sure you have Record gallery view with shared screen selected
1. Unselect Record active speaker with shared screen and Record active speaker, gallery view and shared screen separately.
Remember to save.

You can also read through General information on recording on the zoom support here

How to identify the meeting host with the permission to record

You can use one of the below methods to find this information after joining the meeting.

1. Via participants sidebar.

1. Navigate to the participants icon on the bottom of the window.
1. You will be presented with the list of participants on the right panel of the window.
1. The host will be listed in parentheses at the end of their name. (A resize of the participants window may be needed).
1. Via meeting info pop-up.
1. Navigate to the upper left corner, where you will be presented with an i icon.
1. Select the icon to locate the meeting host who will have the ability to record the call.

How to allow recording when the host is not present

This usually happens on recurring meetings where the host can't always attend.

The meeting creator should add colleagues as "Alternative Hosts" in case they can't attend so that others can still start the recording.

Using the website:

1. Navigate to <https://gitlab.zoom.us/meeting/<meeting id>/edit>.
1. Scroll to the bottom to find "Alternative Hosts".
1. Add the email address for one or more colleagues separated by a comma.
1. Click Save.

Using the Zoom app:

1. Click "Meetings".
1. Find your meeting on the left-hand side of the app.
1. Click "Edit" on the right-hand side of the app.
1. Expand the "Advanced Options" drop-down on the bottom of the window.
1. Find the "Alternative Hosts" box at the bottom.
1. Add the email address for one or more colleagues separated by a semi-comma.
1. Click Save.

Recording video transcripts

Closed captioning and live transcription is enabled by default for all users, however the subtitles will not show for participants unless a host manually enables it once the meeting starts.

At the end of a recorded meeting, the transcription will be available in a text file under the same folder as the other recording files.

For local recordings, a transcription is saved to closedcaption.txt but only if enabled by a co-host.

For cloud recordings, the file name ends with .transcript.txt and the full transcription is always available. Processing takes about 15 minutes, so the video files appear before the

transcription.

Zoom AI Companion

Meeting Summary with AI Companion

1. Start a meeting with the Zoom desktop client.
1. Click AI Companion in the meeting control toolbar to activate its automatic "Meeting Summary" feature
1. Make sure that Meeting summary option is selected.
1. Participants will see a notification that AI Companion is active and analyzing the discussion.
1. Once the meeting ends, the summary will be emailed to the meeting host and meeting invitees in our organization.

Accessing AI Companion Meeting Summaries

1. Go to your Zoom account's profile.
1. In the sidebar expand AI Companion and then click on Meeting Summary.
1. To edit or share, click on a meeting topic and you will have the option to Share, Edit, or Delete meeting summaries.

Accessing AI Companion Smart Recordings

1. Go to your Zoom account's profile.
1. In the sidebar click on Recordings, your smart recordings will be under Cloud Recordings.

Enabling email notifications for hosts when attendees join first

1. Go to your Zoom account settings.
1. Click the Meeting tab.
1. Under Email notification, click the When attendees join meeting before host toggle to enable or disable it.

How to share a presentation in Zoom

At some point, you may need to give a slide presentation using Zoom. Ideally, you should be able to see your speaker notes while participants see your slide show. This is fairly easy to do with two monitors by using presenter view and sharing the monitor which contains the slides.

If you have only one monitor, it is still possible using the following steps:

1. Open your slide deck in Google Slides.
Make sure to close any other tabs you may have open.
Participants will be able to see these tabs when it comes time to present.
1. Select Presenter view.
This will make your presentation take up the entire window for participants, but not your entire monitor.
If you want to switch to this view from the standard Present view you can simply press the a key.

1. Hover near the bottom of your presentation and you will see a pop up menu.

From this menu, select the Toggle Full Screen option, third button from the right, next to settings.

This will end full screen mode without leaving the presenter view.

1. To see your speaker notes, hover at the bottom of your presentation window again and select Presenter View from the menu.

1. You will now have a presenter view pop-up window which allows you to see your speaker notes as well as advance the slides.

1. In another browser window enter the Zoom meeting room.

1. Once in the meeting, select Share Screen from the options at the bottom of the screen.

1. Do not share your desktop.

From the options, select the browser window containing your Google Slides deck.

This will allow you to share just the browser window containing your slides.

1. If you would also like to see the Zoom chat, hover your cursor at the top of the screen containing your Zoom meeting.

A menu will appear, from this menu select More > Chat.

1. Position the windows any way you need to see the presentation and speaker notes.

1. Make sure to change slides using the presenter view pop up window.

This will advance the presentation for your viewers as well as advancing your speaker notes.

1. Make sure the minimum font size of text is large enough so that it can easily be read by everyone.

If you would like to practice presenting, you can do so using your own private Zoom room.

1. Open the Zoom app and click Start with video.

1. Click Record.

1. Repeat the steps above.

1. Stop and watch the recording. You'll see what the participants would see.

Sharing your screen in Zoom

Sharing a document is not recommended in Zoom. Instead, participants can follow along in the document themselves. The link to the document should be included in the meeting invite.

If you share your screen (for a document despite above recommendation, for a web based application demo, for an ssh session, etc.) it is recommended that you increase the font size so that the text can easily be read by those who are farsighted.

If you share your screen in zoom, please wait until after introductions have been completed to allow participants to see each other clearly during introductions. This is especially important during external calls when participants are meeting each other for the first time.

Using a phone to connect to audio

Especially when talking with customers, it's good to make a good impression! One way is to use a phone to dial in, which can increase reliability of your audio connection and reduce latency. In general, a landline has the lowest latency, a mobile phone is next, and internet audio is variable.

Here are some tips for quick and effective telephone connections to Zoom meetings.

- Some meeting rooms have the "Call me" option; others don't.
To make it easier to dial in, keep Zoom as a contact so you can dial it quickly.
- If you dial in, Zoom will ask for the Meeting ID.
If the meeting hasn't started yet, the Meeting ID won't appear in the Zoom client.
But it's in the URL, and you can still connect to the audio with the phone.
Then when the meeting starts, your audio and video will both connect instantly.
- If the meeting URL has a name rather than an ID, just click the URL and get the ID from the browser URL bar (might not work in Safari?); the name is just a redirect, and with the Meeting ID you can connect on the phone quickly.
- The phone will also ask for your Participant ID.
If you don't give it when you first connect, your audio and video might appear in separate boxes in the Zoom window, as if you're in the meeting twice.
That's confusing to others, as your video won't be highlighted when you talk.
To merge the two connections, on your phone, press the , followed by your Participant ID, followed by again.
Zoom will merge the two connections without annoying others on the call.
- Even if you're using the phone for audio, use the mute button in the Zoom client for muting.
That tells others on the call that you're muted.

Considerations when presenting on Zoom

Maintaining audience engagement

Check in with your Audience: There are multiple stages throughout your Zoom presentation or video conference which are prime points to engage the audience with a simple check-in.

- At the beginning of the presentation: You could check in with your audience as soon as you have explained the upcoming meeting/presentation agenda, this will help to make sure that everyone understands the journey you're about to take them on.
- After delivering the initial value prop: You should most certainly check in after delivering GitLab's value proposition or key message.
It's generally best to use people's names e.g. John, Ryan, please let me know if there is anything you would like me to clarify in more detail? By using names in this way will force a response, show that you are engaged with them directly and keep the audience tuned in.

Involve the remote audience when presenting

There are a number of simple methods presenters can use to involve the participants throughout your presentation.

- Direct Reference: 'As most of you will be aware.' or 'Some of you might be wondering.' and good phrases to grab your participants' attention and make them feel involved as well as reinforce your own position as a subject matter expert.
- Rhetorical Questions: Rhetorical questions generally encourage the participant to formulate answers to your question for discussion at a later point in the presentation.
This method can be good to highlight a point that you want the participant to recall later during the presentation.
- Acknowledge Challenges: Acknowledging the impact of your message upon the audience to help enforce you as a trusted GitLab representative of their interests.

Keeping a Remote Audience on Track

- Always have an agenda: Having a clear agenda will help set expectations.

With longer presentations, you may wish to summarize where you've been and where you are up to within your agenda.

- Put emphasis on your key message: Because of the constant barrage of emails, texts, calls, and social media updates, participants joining via Zoom (or any video conferencing tool) can easily get distracted and quickly tune out.

Bring their attention back to you and your presentation by making sure you really emphasize your key message.

You will sound much more focused, and thereby, help remote attendees relate points and examples back to the core of your presentation or meeting.

- Refer Directly to Your Slides: Refer directly to your presentation or meeting slides, particularly those that are more complex and which you should spend more time explaining (e.g. with graphs graphics or flow diagrams).

It's important to verbally indicated to the audience where you are on the slide by using the mouse cursor or virtual laser dot.

Remember to Breathe

Harness the power of pausing to help people keep up and absorb what you're sharing is even more important in a removed presenting environment.

That's because, without an audience in front of us, we tend to speed up and truncate our pauses even more.

So be extra mindful of this and of your audience.

At the end of the day, listeners lost means a missed opportunity to get your message across.

Make the participant experience an enjoyable one

Video calling via Zoom and other technologies is incredibly useful and convenient but can make presentations dull and boring for both the audience and the presenter.

For this reason, it's even more important to find ways to build rapport and to have fun and inject some humor into the meeting (if possible).

It's important that you give yourself, and the audience, the permission to have some banter and moments of 'lightness' during the presentation.

Don't take the entire experience too seriously or you'll bleed the presentation dry of any interactivity.

Therefore it is good to allow your natural personality to shine through.

This will refresh the presentation with an air of genuine spirit, much needed when your audience is remote and cannot interact with you in person.

Remember, if you sound like you're enjoying hosting the meeting, the audience is more likely to enjoy listening to it. Find other tips for increasing user engagement from our live speaker series with Lorraine Lee on all-remote video and presentation tips

Provide links rather than sharing while you present or edit

Provide links (to merge requests, issues, documents, etc) rather than sharing your screen while you present/edit. This allows participants to follow along at their own pace and independently make comments/edits.

Additional Zoom tips

Zoom on Linux using FOSS (Firejail)

While Zoom works on Linux, the application is not free software. As a result, some might be wary of running this directly on their computer. One way of running Zoom without worrying about what it does is to use firejail.

To use Zoom with Firejail, first install Zoom or download the archive. Zoom offers standalone binaries that you can download should your distribution not have a package for Zoom. Once installed, install firejail.

Once both firejail and Zoom are installed we need two things:

1. A firejail profile for Zoom

1. A directory we can use as the home directory for Zoom, preventing it from messing with your home directory

You can use the following firejail profile and store it in `~/.config/firejail/zoom.profile`:

```
conf
noblacklist ~/.config/zoomus.conf

include /etc/firejail/zoom.local
include /etc/firejail/disable-common.inc
include /etc/firejail/disable-programs.inc
include /etc/firejail/disable-devel.inc

whitelist ~/.zoom

caps.drop all
netfilter
newprives
noroot
protocol unix,inet,inet6,netlink
seccomp

private-tmp
```

Next we need a home directory for Zoom. For this example we'll use `/opt/zoom/home`:

```
bash
sudo mkdir -p /opt/zoom/home
sudo chown -R $USER /opt/zoom
```

```
bash
```



```
firejail --quiet --profile=~/.config/firejail/zoom.profile --private=/opt/zoom/home  
/path/to/zoom/ZoomLauncher
```

Note that you must start the ZoomLauncher binary and not the shell script wrapper called zoom.

Virtual background

With or without a physical green screen.

Consider using a customizable GitLab Background (Google Drive access available to GitLab team members who are logged in).

1. In your Zoom In Meeting (Advanced) settings, enable Virtual background
1. In your Zoom application on your computer, open settings and click on the Virtual Background setting
1. Select a background you want to use, or click the [+] to add a picture from your computer.
1. A video on how to set up a Virtual Background with Zoom is available [here](#)
1. If you do not have a green screen, consider using a Virtual Background that is a similar color to whatever is behind you.

Applying Video Filters

1. Sign into the Zoom desktop client.
1. Click on your profile picture > Settings.
1. Click the Background & Effects tab.
1. Click the Video Filters tab.
1. Select the desired filter. (We have GitLab themed filters!)
1. (Optional) Scroll down and select the Apply to all future meetings checkbox to set this filter as a default for all meetings you join or host.

External webcams and DSLRs

It is possible to achieve high quality video output with a professional bokeh effect by using a DSLR or external webcam.

External webcams are generally a good alternative to your built in Macbook webcam as they allow for more control such as advanced color and light correction including white balance and contrast adjustments.

External webcams also allow you to crop your live image concentrating on a certain part of your video i.e. your face.

1. An up to date list of Mac compatible external webcams can be found [here](#).
1. Setting up a DSLR to work as a webcam with your Mac can be quite complicated and will generally require additional hardware such as adapters.

A simple video tutorial of how to set up your DSLR as a webcam with your Mac can be found [here](#).

Zoom and silencing the Chrome "Open Zoom Meetings" popup

Video calling with Zoom and Chrome often has the annoying popup before every call where you

have to click the popup "Open Zoom Meetings".

There used to be a checkbox in Chrome that you could select in order to tell Chrome to Always open these types of links in the associated app - Zoom.

The checkbox option was removed in Chrome in September 2019 according to this Chrome support thread, this meant that every time you started a Zoom meeting from Chrome, you would have to click the popup and 'Open Zoom Meetings' a second time for the meeting to actually start the meeting.

In the above Chrome support thread, the following macOS solution is listed:

> For macOS:

>

> Open Terminal and enter:

>

> defaults write com.google.Chrome ExternalProtocolDialogShowAlwaysOpenCheckbox -bool true

>

> Quit and restart Chrome to see the checkbox

Once you do this, when you start your next Zoom meeting, just check the box to always trust Zoom and you'll never see it again.

Zoom automatically lowering your microphone input volume

If you have a loud keyboard or a fan in your office, Zoom may try to automatically reduce your microphone input volume. This can be frustrating because then other participants have trouble hearing you speak later in the call.

If you are experiencing this issue, go into your Zoom client settings and uncheck "Automatically adjust microphone volume".

Google Calendar Add-on for Zoom

To make it easy to set up Zoom sessions for your calendar events, enable the Google Calendar add-on for Zoom.

This adds a dropdown option right inside of Google Calendar to add Zoom to the event.

When users view the event, they will see specially formatted Zoom details that includes the link to the meeting, and a clickable phone number if they are dialing in.

The add-on will also follow your preferences in your Zoom account for using your personal link or a unique link.

Create a Persistent Zoom Room

If you find yourself wanting to have a persistent Zoom "Room" for shared use by anybody on your team at any time, do this:

1. Login to the Zoom website

1. Go to the Meetings section

1. Click "Schedule a Meeting"

1. Enter the desired topic (title)

1. Click "Recurring meeting"
1. Under "Recurrence", select "No Fixed Time"
1. In the options area, be sure to select "Allow participants to join anytime"
1. Click "Save"
1. Share the link to the room with your intended users

Settings for smaller meetings

If you have a smaller meeting (4 or fewer participants) and want to allow for quicker starts, you could change the settings on a per meeting basis to remove the waiting room, or default audio to on (can be overridden by participants local settings). To quickly do this, you can:

1. Install the Zoom Scheduler Chrome Extension
1. When creating a meeting, click on Make it a Zoom Meeting
1. Uncheck Waiting Room
1. Ensure Host and Participant Video is On
1. Ensure Mute participants upon entry is unchecked
1. Click Continue

This should allow for a bit more of a seamless transition into beginning a smaller meeting. The defaults for larger meetings are still what's documented above.

SECTION: tools-and-tips/ai/_index.md

This handbook section contains useful tips for working with AI at GitLab. GitLab team members should be familiar with the General Purpose AI Tool Usage Guidelines.

Usage guidelines and FAQs

Approved AI Tools

If your requested AI tool is not included in this list, seek approval via the processes described in this section. Please refer to the General Purpose AI Tool Usage Guidelines for guidance on the use of general purpose AI tools in your work at GitLab.

GitLab Duo

Available in: IDEs and GitLab.com UI

How to use: GitLab Duo documentation, GitLab Duo Tips

Data Classification: Red

Anthropic Claude.ai

Available as: Web interface

How to use: Claude.ai Tips

Data Classification: Orange

Other approved AI tools

Some AI features in existing Tech Stack systems may also be approved for use. To learn more, see the General Purpose AI Tool Usage Guidelines.

Prohibited AI tools

Examples of tools that are not permitted for use at GitLab:

OpenAI ChatGPT.

Microsoft/GitHub Copilot.

Google Chrome AI features (for example: "Help me write").

Apple Intelligence.

Third-party platforms that connect to Claude that aren't